
How do we come together?

You have probably completed an intensive and innovative phase in which you developed a transdisciplinary education module together with a team. On paper, it all makes sense. But now you are moving on to the next phase; implementing your education.

In this path, we give you information and concrete tips on how to actually implement and do what you have designed, conceived and created.

Before we share the concrete tips with you, we first describe two key aspects of implementing and doing transdisciplinary education: creating a safe learning environment and ensuring equality.

Safe learning environment

A safe learning environment is characterised by an environment in which team members feel safe, i.e. without fear of negative consequences, to take interpersonal risks such as sharing ideas, asking questions, admitting mistakes or asking for help (Edmondson & Harvey, 2018). Creating a safe learning environment within a transdisciplinary educational setting is challenging due to the wide diversity of group members, among others. Nevertheless, a number of concrete tips emerge from literature and practice that help ensure a safe learning environment. These can be found at the torch with concrete tips.

In transdisciplinary collaboration, equality refers to the idea that all those involved, regardless of their background, discipline or expertise, make an equally valuable and necessary contribution to the process. This principle is crucial in transdisciplinary work because it brings together not only academic disciplines, but also practitioners, stakeholders and sometimes even citizens to address complex societal issues.

Some key aspects of equality in transdisciplinary collaboration:

- 1. Valuing different types of knowledge:** In transdisciplinary teams, not only scientific knowledge is valued, but also practical knowledge, local knowledge and experiential knowledge. This means that each team member is seen as an equal partner, regardless of their formal training or expertise.
- 2. Sharing decision-making and responsibility:** Equality means that decisions are not made hierarchically by only the scientists or experts, but that all stakeholders have a say. This ensures shared responsibility and ownership over the project and its outcomes.
- 3. Respect for diverse perspectives:** Transdisciplinary collaboration requires all participants to be open to the ideas and approaches of others. The input of others is actively listened to and reflected upon, without bias to any particular perspective.
- 4. Mutual learning:** Equivalence also means that participants learn from each

other. Scientists learn from practical experiences, while stakeholders gain insight into scientific methods. This mutual learning is fundamental to developing solutions that are applicable and effective in practice.

Degree of stakeholder involvement

When designing transdisciplinary education, you have devised and elaborated different learning activities in the different phases of the project (explore problem, define problem, work on problem and disseminate results). Depending on the phase and the (learning) activity, partners are involved to a certain extent. Make thoughtful choices in this and adjust where necessary during the implementation of education.

The graph below discusses the extent of stakeholder involvement in a process.

Note that this graph shows an upward trend in degree of involvement, not in value.

In transdisciplinary education, it is advisable to stagger between consulting and cooperating, with a possibility of outliers in informing and supporting.

INCREASING STAKEHOLDER INFLUENCE ON THE RESEARCH

	INFORM	CONSULT	INVOLVE	COLLABORATE	SUPPORT
STAKEHOLDER PARTICIPATION GOAL	Researchers provide stakeholders with balanced and objective information to assist them in understanding the research.	Researchers obtain stakeholder feedback on the research.	Researchers work directly with stakeholders to ensure that stakeholder concerns and aspirations are consistently understood and considered in the research.	Researchers develop equal partnerships with stakeholders for undertaking the research.	Researchers provide input as requested to stakeholder-led research.
PROMISE MADE TO STAKEHOLDERS BY RESEARCHERS	We will keep you informed.	We will keep you informed, listen to and acknowledge your concerns and aspirations and provide feedback on how your input influenced the research.	We will work with you to ensure your concerns and aspirations are directly reflected in the research and we will provide feedback on how your input influenced the research.	We will include you as an equal partner in designing and conducting the research.	We will provide advice and assistance as requested to help you design and conduct your research.